

SPARKASSE

Social-First Banking for Gen Z

" Trust is the trend."

MISSION OVERVIEW

01 Identify Sparkasse's communicative gap within the Gen Z market

02 Define a bold Social-First positioning anchored in responsibility and relevance.

03 Design a platform-native initiative

04 Integrate AI as a functional enabler.

05 Develop a clear business rationale (ROI logic & long-term impact)

06 Teams may work with clearly stated assumptions where needed

Identify Sparkasse's communicative gap within the Gen Z market

"Sparkasse speaks where Gen Z isn't, in a language Gen Z doesn't understand, in a way Gen Z doesn't trust."

01

Channel Gap

Branch vs Social Feed

52% willing to open accounts
on social

02

Information Gap

Complex language vs TikTok 30 sec

43% willing to sign contracts
on social

03

Value Gap

Invisible Trust

36% of conversion driven by
brand visibility

04

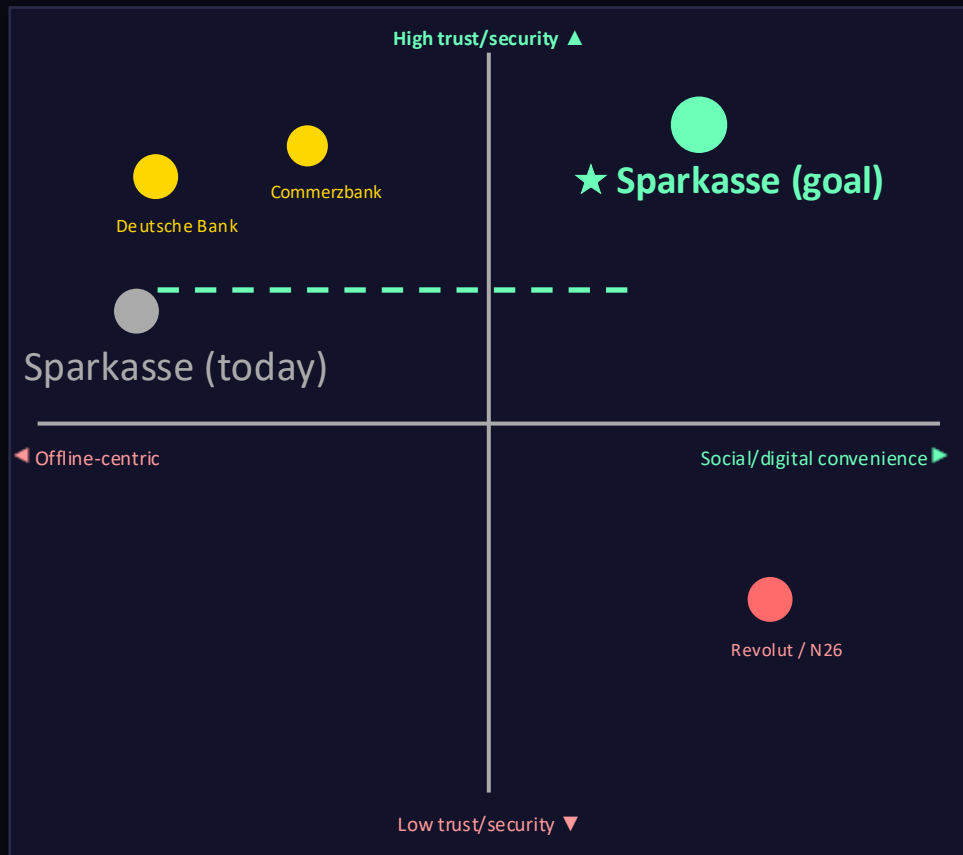
Influence Gap

Ads vs Influencers

21% influencer impact +
30% trendy boost ↑

Conclusion: "Trust exists — but invisible trust is the same as no trust. To Gen Z, Sparkasse is an unknown bank."

Social First Positioning



POSITIONING STATEMENT

We no longer ask you to come to the branch.
We come to your feed.

"Trust is the new trend."

ATM Sparkasse's Unique Strength

Tens of thousands of ATMs across Germany
 Germany's cash culture → ATM = essential infrastructure
 Strength neobanks & big banks cannot match

✗ Neobanks

Convenience ✓
 Trust ✗ ATM ✗

▲ Big Banks

Trust ✓
 Social ✗ Local ✗

Sparkasse = Trust ✓ Social ✓ ATM ✓ Local presence ✓

Platform-Native Initiative: Sparkasse

 **Benchmark:** Korea's Toss Bank

"Germany doesn't have Toss yet. Sparkasse can become that — but with the trust of a real bank."

USER JOURNEY



Core Features

Social One-Stop Account Opening

CORE

AI facial recognition + ID scan in Instagram/TikTok feed
→ Account opened in 3 minutes
No app download. No leaving the feed.

All-in-One Asset Management

TOSS

Connect all cards/accounts including neobank
Spending patterns + payment dates + balance at a glance
Bank certificate issued instantly

Neobank SOS Emergency Support

UNIQUE

Account freeze detected → Contact via social DM
Emergency account activated within 24 hours
Based on international student/working holiday experience

AI Feature Integration

"Sparkasse AI doesn't ask Gen Z. It already knows — and tells you first."

Currency Exchange Alert

International Students /
Working Holiday

Real-time exchange rate monitoring → AI pattern analysis →
Alert at target rate → Exchange with one tap

Payment Prediction System

Prevent Account Freeze

Card payment date + balance → AI pre-calculates → '€40 short
in 5 days' → Transfer early or pull from savings

Spending Pattern Analysis

Core of All-in-One App

All cards + neobank connected → AI auto-categorizes →
Income/spending/savings at a glance → 'Food budget €200
over this month'

Social Savings Challenge

Viral Growth + Deposit
Increase

AI calculates **saveable** amount → Set goal (e.g. €900) → Share
as Instagram/TikTok challenge → Friends join together

AI = Not just a chatbot — a social friend that knows your finances better than you do

ROI Business Rationale & Assumptions



FX Fee Revenue

Assumption: 500K international students/working holiday in Germany

Recover FX fees lost to neobanks



Lifetime Customer (LTV)

Assumption: 1 Gen Z customer LTV = €15,000

Cross-sell loans/insurance
Loan/insurance cross-sell



Deposit Growth

Assumption: €150/month savings × 3 viral friends

Customer acquisition cost €0 via savings challenge



New Customer Acquisition

Conservative assumption: 20% conversion rate applied

20% conversion rate = 20K new customers per year

Long-term Impact

Short-term: Year 1

Gen Z acquisition & neobank churn prevention



Mid-term: Year 3

Main account = Sparkasse
Loan/insurance cross-sell



Long-term: Year 5+

Default bank for Germany's Gen Z

CONCLUSION

Sparkasse

Mission 1

Channel · Info · Value · Influence
4 Communication Gaps Identified

Mission 2

Trust is the Trend
Social-First Positioning

Mission 3

Sparkasse
Platform-Native Service

Mission 4

AI: FX Alert · Payment Prediction
Spending Analysis · Savings Challenge

Mission 5

LTV · Deposits · New Customers
Business ROI

Mission 6

Data-Driven Logic
with Reasonable Assumptions

***"Investing in Sparkasse is not the cost of building an app.
It is the cost of securing Germany's entire Gen Z as lifetime customers."***